questions to the state or states concerned, or to the Security Council or to both. Any such question on which action is necessary shall be referred to the Security Council by the General Assembly either before or after the discussion. The General Assembly may also call the attention of the Security Council to situations which are likely to endanger international peace and security.

Under Article 14, subject to the provisions of Article 12, the General Assembly may recommend measures for the peaceful adjustment of any situation, regardless of origin, which it deems likely to impair the general welfare or friendly relations among nations, including situations resulting from a violation of the provisions of the present Charter setting forth the purposes and principles of the United Nations.

The 1950s, during the Korean crisis, saw an increase in the importance of the General Assembly. In the backdrop of the Cold War and the continuous tussle between the USA and the USSR resulting in the exercise of veto, and later due to the continuous absence by the Soviet Union, the Security Council reached a deadlock. It was then that the historical “Uniting for Peace Resolution (UPR)”, 1950, was adopted by virtue of which “action with respect to threats to the peace, breaches of the peace and acts of aggression”, which is solely the responsibility of the Security Council, would be performed by the General Assembly. It was resolved that “if the Security Council, because of lack of unanimity of the permanent members, fails to exercise its primary responsibility for the maintenance of international peace and security in any case where there appears to be a threat to the peace, breach of the peace, or act of aggression, the General Assembly shall consider the matter immediately with a view to making appropriate recommendations to Members for collective measures, including in the case of a breach of the peace or act of aggression the use of armed force when necessary, to maintain or restore international peace and security. If not in session at the time, the General Assembly may meet in emergency special session within twenty-four hours of the request. Such emergency special session shall be called if requested by the Security Council on the vote of any seven members, or by a majority of the Members of the United Nations”.[9]